What is this thing?

Lesson 1 notes. Fill in the blanks as we go.

What a language model is

A language model read an enormous amount of text and learned which words tend to _____ which.

When you ask it something, it writes an answer one piece at a time, each time picking a _____ next piece.

Two things it is not

- **Not a search engine.** It does not _____ things up unless something hands it sources.
- **Not a person who knows.** It sounds the same when it's right and when it's _____.

A confident wrong answer is called a _____.

It sounds sure either way, so check it against something _____.

Every answer has two parts

	1. The overview	2. Books in our library
Who wrote it?	The model, in its _____ words	Our Catalog: these are _____ books
What should I do?	Treat it as a start, and check it	Use the Citation (title and call number) to find the book

This can be wrong. Check the source.

Your Card

- It lets your group use the assistant for this period.
- It has a number on it. The assistant never learns your name.
- The librarian can see the questions, with the Card number.
- Don't type your full name, address, or phone number, or anyone else's.

Our group's questions

For each answer, write down what you saw.

Our question	Did it have Citations? How many?	Did it sound sure?

Take it with you

- A language model **predicts likely next words**. It doesn't look facts up on its own.
- It **sounds just as sure** when it's guessing as when it's right.
- The **overview** is the model talking. **Books in our library** are real books we own.
- The overview is often a good start, and it can be wrong about anything. Checking is how you use it well, not a sign that it's broken.
- This assistant runs on a computer in our building.

Check yourself

1. Why can a language model sound sure and still be wrong?
2. Name two things a language model is not.
3. What does "check the source" ask you to do? What is the source?